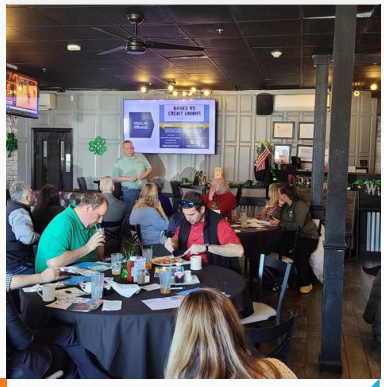
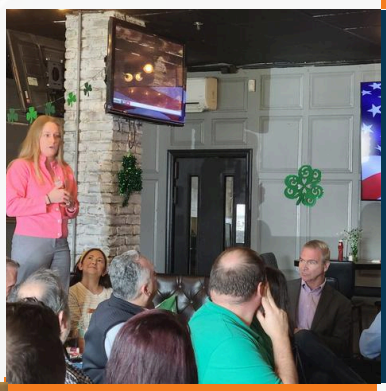
SBNA
SMALL BUSINESS NETWORKING ALLIANCE

Small Business Networking Alliance **Handbook**

- ***GIVE***
- ***LEARN***
- ***EDUCATE***











Welcome to SBNA

WHO WE ARE

At SBNA, we believe in the power of connections. We formed our chapters as an alternative to high-cost corporate networking groups, providing a more affordable and personable experience.

We're a non-profit organization dedicated to helping our members succeed through:

- 🌟 **Genuine Relationships:** Building trust and lasting connections.
- 📚 **Continuous Learning:** Sharing knowledge and best practices.
- 📈 **Business Growth:** Supporting each other's professional journeys.

Our Mission

Our mission is simple but powerful:

"Building each week a powerful and trusting community of business owners and entrepreneurs who support each other by sharing knowledge, participating in business education, and helping each other grow our businesses by sharing quality leads and referrals."

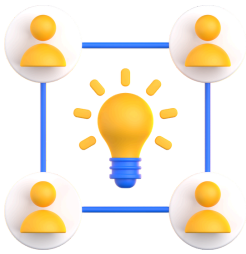
Our Values

At SBNA, we live by three core values:

- **GIVE** 🤝**:** We believe in the power of generosity and the principle of giving first.
- **LEARN** 📖**:** We're committed to continuous learning and sharing knowledge.
- **EDUCATE** 🧠**:** We aim to educate each other and the community to foster growth and success.

Tagline

GIVE, LEARN, EDUCATE







Building each week a powerful and trusting community of business owners and entrepreneurs who **support each other** by sharing knowledge, participating in business education, and **helping each other grow** our businesses by sharing quality leads and referrals

Weekly Agenda

RECIPE FOR SUCCESS

Weekly Agenda: ✨📈

Welcome to our SBNA Networking Lunch Group! Here's the format of our dynamic and engaging weekly meetings. We strive to create a productive and friendly environment where everyone can thrive. 🌟

1. Networking 🤝Start your visit with 15-30 minutes of casual networking. Mingle, chat, and connect with other business owners and professionals.
2. Visitors & Substitutes Welcome 🌟 The SBNA Member who invited you will introduce you to the group. Feel the warmth and camaraderie as you get to know our members.
3. SBNA Mission and Testimonial/Educational Tips 📚 A brief 2-minute segment where we share our mission, best practices, and educational tips.
4. 45-60 Second Member Commercials 📢 Each member stands and gives a 45-60 second "Commercial" (Name, Business, what you do, what is a good referral for you this week, and your business "Tag" Line). All members first, then substitutes and guests.
5. SBNA Weekly Reports 📝 Updates from our President, VP, and Treasurer on the latest group happenings.
6. Weekly Speaker 🎤 One member will have 15 minutes (For speaking and questions) to dive deeper into their businesses and share insights.
7. Weekly Referrals and Testimonials 💼 Members share referrals and testimonials within 45 seconds. Remember, *guests cannot receive referrals until they are a member*!
8. Referral Check / Speaker's Door Prize 🎁 Celebrate successful referrals and win exciting door prizes from our weekly speakers.
9. Events and Community Activities 📅 Let the group know about upcoming events and community activities.
10. Quote of the Week 💬 A motivational quote to inspire and energize everyone for the week ahead.
11. Closing of Meeting 🛑
Wrap up the meeting and head back to your business, ***motivated and connected.***

Note:

- Visitors may visit twice. An application may be completed on the first or second visit.
- At your first visit, the lunch is complimentary. At the second visit, the lunch fee of $20 will be collected.
- Visitors are interviewed by the membership committee. If a visitor is submitting an application, there will be three minutes at the end of the meeting for members to ask questions. You may be asked to leave the meeting a few minutes early so that the group can vote on your possible membership.

We look forward to seeing you at our next meeting! 🌟🍽️

1

Policies/Regulations

GUIDELINES FOR GREATNESS

SBNA
SMALL BUSINESS NETWORKING ALLIANCE

1. **One Member Per Profession** 📌: Only one person from each professional classification can join. Membership committees have the final say on classification conflicts.
2. **Primary Occupation Only** 💼: Members must represent their primary occupation (30+ hours per week), not a part-time business.
3. **Attendance and Punctuality** 🕒: Weekly meetings last 90 minutes. Members should arrive on time and stay for the entire meeting. Arriving late or leaving early (more than 5 times per quarter) will result in forfeiting the right to present your 60-second commercial.
4. **Weekly Speaker** 🎤: Each week, there is one featured speaker that will have the opportunity to teach us more about their business. The speaker must bring a door prize 🎁. Only members who bring a visitor, participate in a one-to-one, or provide a referral are eligible for the door prize.
5. **Attendance is Key** 🔑: If you can't attend, send a substitute. This won't count as an absence. You are allowed three absences per quarter. More than three absences in a quarter jeopardizes your membership. Persistent absences may result in termination.
6. **Bring Referrals, Visitors, and Participate** 🤝: Members are required to bring at least one referral, visitor, or participate in a one-to-one each week. You need a minimum of 4 points per month. Failing this, your membership will be reviewed.
7. **Visitor Policy** 🕵️: Visitors can attend twice. The first lunch is complimentary 🍽️, and the second visit requires a meal fee ($20). Visitors are interviewed by the membership committee and voted in by a 75% majority.
8. **Filing Concerns** 📝: If a visitor conflicts with your classification, file a concern with the Membership Committee before the visitor is voted in. No complaints mean consent is assumed.
9. **Changing Classification** 🔄: To change your professional classification, submit a new membership application for approval.
10. **Handling Issues** ⚖️: The Membership Committee can put a member on probation for business practices or commitment issues with a majority agreement from the committee and leadership team.
11. **Membership Compliance** ✅: A member's seat can be opened for failure to comply with policies and ethics, requiring a majority vote by the Membership Committee and Leadership Team.
12. **Referral List Use** 📜: The membership roster is for giving referrals, not for soliciting without prior SBNA approval.
13. **New Member Orientation** 🎓: All new members must have a 30-minute meeting with a Mentor Coach within the first two weeks to review policies, referral practices, and how to invite visitors.
14. **Licensing Requirements** 📜: Members in professions requiring a valid New York State license must maintain an active and good-standing license. Licenses will be validated before membership renewal

Policies/Regulations

GUIDELINES FOR GREATNESS

SBNA
SMALL BUSINESS NETWORKING ALLIANCE

Administrative Policies 📄

- **Community Activity Dues** 💵: $240 per year, non-refundable. Payment plans can be requested.
- **Meal Dues Refunds** 🍽️: Departing members in good standing can request a refund for the unused portion of meal dues. Meal dues are $20 per week, paid quarterly.
- **Non-Transferable Dues** 🔄: Community Activity Dues cannot be transferred unless from the same company.
- **Returned Checks** ❌: Returned checks must be resolved within three working days. There is a $25 fee for returned checks. A second NSF check will result in termination.

Absences and Tardiness 🕰️

- **Absence Definition**: Your chair is empty with no one representing you.
- **Reporting Absences** 📞: Call or report to the President or Vice President before the meeting. No-shows are unacceptable.
- **Absentee Policy:**
  - Three absences per quarter permitted.
  - At three absences, a written warning will be issued.
  - Four absences result in losing the next spot in the speaking rotation, and membership is jeopardized.
  - Second occurrence of four absences in a fiscal year will result in the seat being vacated.
  - Fifth absence in a quarter without a substitute results in termination. Prepaid meal dues are refunded, but membership dues are not.

Substitute Program 🗂️

- **Substitute List** 📋: A list of available substitutes will be maintained.
- **Finding Substitutes** 🔍: Consider customers, clients, friends, family, employees, and potential members.
- **Substitute Participation** 🎙️: Substitutes can present a 60-second commercial after representing the absent member.
- **Notification** 📢: Inform the organization if a substitute is attending. The Visitor Host will greet them.
- **Substitute Usage** 🔄: Substitutes should not replace members continuously.
- **Monthly Limit** 📅: A substitute can visit no more than once a month unless approved by leadership.

Multi-Level Marketing 📈

- **Product Representation:** MLM members should focus on products and services, not the business opportunity.

1

Your weekly commercial

MAKING IT COUNT



Perfecting Your 60-Second Commercial

Welcome to the art of the 60-second commercial! In the fast-paced world of networking, your "elevator pitch" is your chance to shine and make a lasting impression. Here's how to make every second count and maximize your referrals. 🚀✨

Variety is the spice of life, and the same goes for your commercial. Keep things fresh by changing your pitch each week. Here's why:

- 🌟 **Engagement:** A new angle keeps your audience interested.
- 🌟 **Relevance:** Highlighting recent client success stories makes your business relatable.
- 🌟 **Referrals:** Real-world examples help your fellow members identify opportunities to send referrals your way.

Crafting Your Pitch



1. Start with the Basics:

- **Introduce Yourself:** "Hi, I'm [Your Name]."
- **Your Business:** "I represent [Your Business Name], where we [brief description of what you do]."

2. Add a Hook:

- **Engage:** Share an interesting fact or a recent success story.
- **Example:** "Last week, we helped a client save 30% on their annual insurance premium."

3. Be Specific:

- **Target Your Audience:** Describe your ideal client.
- **Example:** "A great referral for me this week would be anyone looking to save on their home insurance."

4. Use Real-World Examples:

- **Relatability:** Share a brief story of how you helped a recent client.
- **Example: "**We recently assisted a family in reducing their mortgage rates, which allowed them to renovate their kitchen."

5. Call to Action:

- **Encourage Engagement:** End with a memorable tagline or a call to action.
- **Example:** "If you know someone looking for financial peace of mind, send them my way! Remember, 'We make your money work harder for you.'

2

Your weekly commercial

MAKING IT COUNT

Pro Tips for a Winning Commercial

- ☑ **Practice Makes Perfect:** Rehearse your pitch to ensure it’s smooth and confident.
- ☑ **Be Authentic:** Genuine enthusiasm can be more compelling than a polished speech.
- ☑ **Stay Within Time:** Keep it concise—60 seconds goes by fast!
- ☑ **Use Visual Aids:** If possible, bring a product sample or a quick handout.
- ☑ **Smile and Make Eye Contact:** Build a connection with your audience.

"You miss 100% of the shots you don’t take." — Wayne Gretzky

Example Commercial Structure

Introduction: "Hi, I’m [Your Name] from [Your Business]."
What You Do: "We specialize in [brief description]."
Recent Success: "Just last week, we helped [client example]."
Ideal Referral: "A perfect referral for us is [describe]."
Call to Action: "Remember, at [Your Business], [tagline]."



By following these tips and continuously refining your pitch, you'll not only keep your audience engaged but also increase your chances of receiving valuable referrals. Happy networking! 🚀🤝

Feel free to reach out if you have any questions or need assistance. We're here to support each other's success!

1

Your featured presentation

MAKING AN IMPRESSION

The Weekly Speaker Spotlight

Every week, one member has the chance to take center stage and dive deeper into their business. This is your opportunity to educate the group on what you do, how you do it, and the best referrals for you. Here's how to make your 10-minute presentation impactful and memorable. 🚀✨

Why Your Presentation Matters

A well-prepared presentation can:

- 🌟 **Educate:** Provide a thorough understanding of your business.
- 🌟 **Engage:** Keep the audience interested and involved.
- 🌟 **Empower:** Equip members with the knowledge to refer you effectively.
-

<u>Structuring Your Presentation</u>

1. Start Strong:

- **Introduction:** "Hi, I'm [Your Name] from [Your Business]."
- **Hook:** Share an intriguing fact or statistic about your industry.
- **Example:** "Did you know that 75% of businesses don't leverage the full potential of [your service]?"

2. Explain What You Do:

- **Overview:** Give a brief description of your services or products.
- **Example:** "At [Your Business], we offer [list of services/products]."

3. Share Success Stories:

- **Real-Life Examples:** Highlight recent successes and how you helped clients.
- **Example:** "Recently, we helped a client increase their sales by 20% by implementing our strategy."

4. Educate the Group:

- **In-Depth Information:** Explain your processes, techniques, or products in more detail.
- **Visual Aids:** Use slides, charts, or handouts to illustrate your points.

5. Highlight Your Ideal Client:

- **Describe Your Target Audience:** Who are the best referrals for you?
- **Example:** "We work best with small to medium-sized businesses looking to grow their online presence.

Your featured presentation

MAKING AN IMPRESSION

6. Call to Action:

- **Engage the Audience:** Encourage questions and interactions.
- **Example:** "If you know a business owner struggling with [problem], I'd love to help them."

7. End on a High Note:

- **Memorable Conclusion:** Summarize key points and leave a lasting impression.
- **Example:** "Remember, at [Your Business], we're not just about [service]; we're about transforming businesses."

Pro Tips for an Engaging Presentation

- **Practice:** Rehearse your presentation to ensure it's smooth and confident.
- **Be Visual:** Use slides, props, or demonstrations to keep the audience engaged.
- **Interactive Elements:** Encourage questions or small activities to involve the audience.
- **Stay Within Time:** Keep your presentation concise and respect the 10-minute limit.
- **Be Passionate:** Show your enthusiasm for your business—it's contagious!

"ACT AS IF WHAT YOU DO MAKES A DIFFERENCE. BECAUSE IT DOES." – WILLIAM JAMES



1

REFERRALS

THE LIFEBLOOD OF SBNA



The Power of Referrals: Building Long-Term Relationships

Referrals are the lifeblood of our networking group! At SBNA, we believe in fostering long-term relationships and emphasizing education. With trust and mutual support, referrals will naturally follow. Here's how to make the most of referrals in our group:

What Makes a Good Referral?

🔗 **Qualified Connections:** A good referral is a specific connection between a member and a potential new client. It's not just about passing along a name; it's about creating an expected and meaningful conversation. This can be done in several ways:

FOLLOW-UP CALL

Exchange information so the member can follow up with a phone call.



IN-PERSON INTRODUCTION

Arrange for a personal introduction between both parties.



GROUP COMMUNICATION

Copy both parties on a group text or email to initiate contact.



🌟 **Expected Conversations:** A qualified referral is an expected interaction, not just posting someone's phone number on Facebook. It ensures both parties are aware and ready for the conversation, making it more productive and meaningful.

Handling Referrals Properly

🚀 **Timely Follow-Up:** When you receive a referral, follow up promptly. Timeliness shows professionalism and respect for the person who referred you.

🤗 **Professional Service:** Always provide courteous and professional service. Remember, a referral reflects on the person who recommended you. Doing a great job not only helps you but also strengthens their reputation.

2

REFERRALS

THE LIFEBLOOD OF SBNA



The Ripple Effect of Good Referrals

✨ **Reflecting Well on Referrers:** If you recommend Bob the Plumber and he does a fantastic job, it reflects positively on you. The client will be thankful and more likely to recommend Bob to others, growing his business and enhancing your reputation as a trusted connector.

📈 **Exponential Growth:** Great referrals can lead to exponential business growth. When clients are happy, they spread the word, creating a network of positive referrals that benefits everyone involved.

Quick Tips for Effective Referrals

- **Be Specific:** Provide clear details about the referral, including the potential client's needs and expectations.
- **Communicate Clearly:** Ensure both parties understand the referral's purpose and expected outcomes.
- **Follow Up:** Check in with both parties after the referral to ensure a successful connection was made.

BUILDING TRUST THROUGH REFERRALS

At SBNA, our focus on long-term relationships and education sets the foundation for strong referrals. Remember, a referral is more than just a business transaction—it's a testament to the trust and respect we have for one another.

With these principles in mind, let's continue to support each other and watch our businesses grow through the power of effective referrals! 🚀⭐

> "A TRUSTED REFERRAL IS THE HOLY GRAIL OF ADVERTISING"
>
> 
>
> -Mark Zuckerberg

Leadership Roles

THE SBNA BACKBONE

SBNA
SMALL BUSINESS NETWORKING ALLIANCE

At SBNA, our members are the backbone of our organization. We believe in the power of collective leadership and encourage all members to step up and take on roles that contribute to the success and vibrancy of our group. Volunteering for a leadership role not only helps in running our meetings smoothly but also provides an excellent opportunity for personal and professional growth.
By taking on these responsibilities, you can enhance your leadership skills, build stronger connections within the group, and make a significant impact on the success of your fellow members. Let's dive into the exciting and rewarding roles available within SBNA!

PRESIDENT

The President is the guiding force of our chapter, ensuring that all meetings run smoothly and that the group remains focused on its goals. They lead the weekly meetings, set the agenda, and ensure that all members have the opportunity to contribute. The President also represents the chapter in external communications and fosters a positive and inclusive atmosphere within the group. This role is perfect for someone who enjoys leadership and wants to make a significant impact on the organization.

VICE PRESIDENT

The Vice President supports the President in their duties and steps in when the President is unavailable. They help with the organization and management of meetings and events, ensuring everything runs seamlessly. The Vice President is also in charge of the weekly roster and speaker rotation, making sure everyone feels valued and included. This role is ideal for someone who is organized, proactive, and enjoys working closely with others to achieve common goals.

TREASURER

The Treasurer manages the financial health of the SBNA. They handle dues collection, budgeting, and financial reporting, ensuring that the organization's funds are used effectively and transparently. The Treasurer plays a vital role in maintaining the group's financial stability and making sure that all financial and tax matters are handled with integrity.

Leadership Roles

THE SBNA BACKBONE

SBNA
SMALL BUSINESS NETWORKING ALLIANCE

MEMBERSHIP

The Membership Committee plays a crucial role in the growth and sustainability of the SBNA. They are responsible for welcoming new members, conducting interviews, and ensuring that the group maintains a diverse and dynamic membership. This committee helps potential members understand the benefits of joining SBNA and supports them through the onboarding process. If you enjoy meeting new people and have a knack for making others feel welcome, this role is for you.

CHAPTER MENTOR

The Chapter Mentor provides guidance and support to new members, helping them integrate smoothly into the group. They share best practices, offer advice, and ensure that new members feel comfortable and confident in participating fully in SBNA activities. This role is perfect for experienced members who want to give back to the group and help others succeed.

SOCIAL MEDIA

The Social Media Committee is responsible for maintaining SBNA's online presence. They create engaging content, manage social media accounts, and promote the group's activities and events. This committee helps to keep members informed and engaged while also attracting new members to the group. If you're savvy with social media and enjoy creative communication, this role is a great fit.

EVENTS COMMITTEE

Events Coordinators are the masterminds behind SBNA's social and networking events. They plan, organize, and execute events that foster camaraderie and provide valuable networking opportunities for members. From happy hours to workshops, Events Coordinators ensure that there's always something exciting happening within the group. If you love planning events and bringing people together, this is the role for you.

Joining SBNA

TAKE THE NEXT STEPS

Joining SBNA is your gateway to a world of opportunities, connections, and business growth. We've taken the best parts of the big corporate networking groups and left behind the high costs and restrictive rules. Here's why you should become a part of our vibrant community of local professionals and business owners!

Why Join SBNA?

- **Boost Your Business:** Imagine having 25+ people dedicated to promoting and supporting your business. That's what it's like when you join SBNA. Our members are always on the lookout for opportunities to refer business your way.

- **Build Lasting Relationships:** We believe in quality over quantity. By allowing only one person per profession, we maximize the value of our relationships and ensure that every member benefits from quality referrals.

- **Learn and Grow:** Our meetings aren't just about networking—they're about learning. With educational tips, testimonials, and presentations, you'll gain valuable insights to help your business thrive.

- **Affordable Networking**: Say goodbye to the high costs of corporate networking groups. SBNA provides all the benefits without breaking the bank.

- **Supportive Community:** When you join SBNA, you're joining a group of like-minded professionals who genuinely care about each other's success. We celebrate each other's wins and provide support through challenges.



Joining SBNA

TAKE THE NEXT STEPS

How to Join SBNA

Visit Us: Start as a visitor if your occupation is open. Attend one of our weekly networking lunch meetings to meet the group and see what we're all about. You'll have the chance to introduce yourself and promote your business.

Experience the Atmosphere: We welcome you with open arms! Feel the energy and enthusiasm as you connect with other local professionals dedicated to helping each other succeed.

Decide to Join: If you love what you see (and we're sure you will!), you can submit an application for membership after your first visit.

Second Visit: If you need a little more time, you're welcome to visit a second time. Just note that you'll need to pay for your lunch on your second visit.

Application Process: Once you submit your application, our membership committee will review it. We take pride in ensuring that each new member is a great fit for our group.

Group Vote: The final step is a vote by the group. We believe in a democratic process to ensure that our community remains strong and cohesive.

Joining SBNA is more than just joining a networking group—it's joining a family. A family that's committed to helping you achieve your business goals. So, what are you waiting for? Come visit us and see how SBNA can help your business grow! 🚀

With these exciting opportunities and a supportive community, there's no better time to join SBNA. We can't wait to welcome you and watch your business soar to new heights!